



Pest-proof plants: slugs

Slug-resistant plants include many beautiful species; there are ranges to suit a variety of different sites and soils.

Slugs attack a wide range of plants and cause severe damage to them as they nibble at the tender, succulent leaves and stems. They are, however, less keen on woody plants and aromatic foliage. While some plants, including cosmos and delphiniums, are never attacked by slugs, others are only consumed when young and tender, but become relatively slug-resistant once mature. To protect them during this vulnerable stage, use small quantities of slug pellets, encircle plants with copper collars—which give slugs a mild electric shock—or surround the stems with sand and grit.



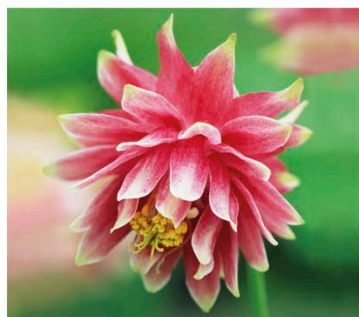
BULB MEDIUM

Allium cristophii

STARS OF PERSIA This perennial bulb has gray-green leaves that wither in early summer, when its large, rounded heads of star-shaped violet flowers form. These dry in the garden, giving slug-proof interest into late summer. Ideal for beds and pots.

↑16in (40cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z5–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Aquilegia vulgaris var. *stellata*

COLUMBINE An upright perennial with tough divided leaves and tall stems of pompomlike double blooms from late spring to early summer. Deadhead often to prevent self-seeding. 'Nora Barlow' (above) has green-tipped pink blooms.

↑30in (75cm) ↔20in (50cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3–8



PERENNIAL LARGE

Aconitum carmichaelii

MONKSHOOD Suitable for the back of a bed, this upright perennial has deeply divided green leaves and tall spikes of hooded lavender-blue flowers in fall. It requires support. 'Arendsii' (above) has rich blue flowers.

↑5ft (1.5m) ↔12in (30cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Alchemilla mollis

LADY'S MANTLE This clump-forming perennial has rounded, pale green leaves with crinkled edges and, in summer, sprays of small lime-green blooms. Best planted in shade, it is ideal for the front of a bed. Trim untidy leaves in summer.

↑↔20in (50cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z4–7



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astilbe 'Venus'

ASTILBE This perennial has coarse heavily divided leaves, unpalatable to slugs and, in midsummer, upright feathery plumes of tiny pale pink flowers, which dry and provide interest into winter. Prefers moist soil when planted in full sun.

↑↔3ft (1m)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3–8



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astrantia major

MASTERWORT A clump-forming perennial with divided midgreen leaves. It produces sprays of small greenish white, pink, or red flowers from midsummer to early fall. Deadhead regularly to prolong the display. It is best on moist but free-draining soil.

↑24in (60cm) ↔18in (45cm)

☀ ☀ ☀ Z4–7



PERENNIAL SMALL

Bergenia purpurascens

PURPLE BERGENIA Perfect for the front of a bed, this evergreen perennial has large, fleshy rounded leaves that spread to form a clump and flush purple in cold weather. It bears dark pink spring-flower clusters. Cut damaged leaves in summer and fall.

↑16in (40cm) ↔24in (60cm) or more

☀ ☀ ☀ Z3–8



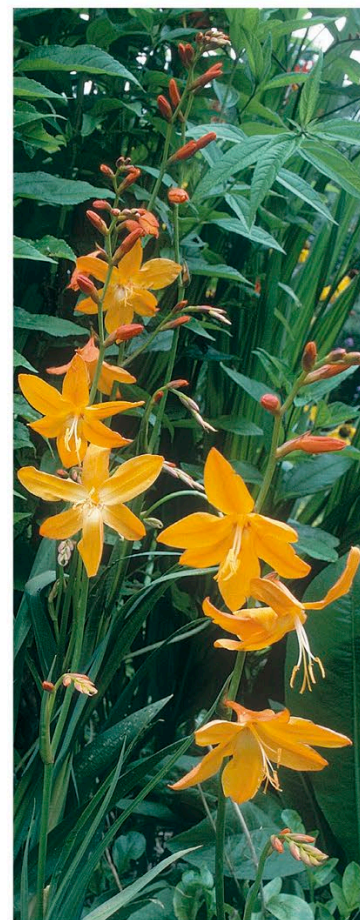
PERENNIAL SMALL

Corydalis lutea

YELLOW CORYDALIS A mound-forming, evergreen perennial with delicate gray-green ferny leaves and, from late spring to summer, heads of small tubular yellow blooms. Suitable for shady and wild gardens but self-seeds freely.

↑↔12in (30cm)

☀ ☀ Z5–7



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Crocsmia x *crocosmiiflora*

MONTBRETIA This upright perennial forms clumps of arching, swordlike green leaves and, from summer to fall, flared, trumpet-shaped yellow, orange, and red flowers. Varieties include 'Star of the East' (above). Considered invasive in some coastal areas.

↑28in (70cm) ↔3in (8cm)

☀ ☀ Z6–9